

SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

The Architecture of *Grace*

Scenario Cards — Book 1

Thirty-four discussion cards for Grades K–2 — two per lesson across four units. Each card carries a short, age-appropriate situation and simple discussion questions. Cards are color-coded by unit. Print, cut along the marked line, and laminate to reuse across classes and years.

How to Use This Deck

Each page holds two scenario cards for a single lesson. Cut along the centre line and laminate for reuse. Read The Situation aloud or display it, then facilitate the Discussion Questions — adapting language as needed for your group.

Cards are color-coded by unit:

-  Unit 1 · Knowing & Accepting Yourself
-  Unit 2 · Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness
-  Unit 3 · Empathy & Forgiving Others
-  Unit 4 · Grace & Generosity

No child is ever required to share personal content in response to a scenario card.

BOOK 1 • THE FOUNDATION • GRADES K-2

UNIT 1 • AUG-OCT

Knowing & Accepting Yourself

Identity • Feelings • Mistakes • Self-Talk

LESSONS IN THIS UNIT

- | | |
|----|-----------------------------------|
| L1 | Who Am I? |
| L2 | My Feelings Are Friends |
| L3 | Everyone Makes Mistakes |
| L4 | My Inside Voice — Kind or Unkind? |
| L5 | Oops vs. I Am Bad |

THE SITUATION

Mia drew a picture of her family and her dog on her Identity Web. A boy in her class said, "That's a baby thing to draw." Mia felt embarrassed.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Mia's family part of who she really is?
- › Why might someone say a mean thing about your drawing?
- › What would you say to Mia to help her feel proud?

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THE SITUATION

Jaylen couldn't think of anything to write on his Identity Web. He kept thinking, "I'm not good at anything."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Do you think Jaylen really isn't good at anything?
- › What might Jaylen's friends say he is good at?
- › Name ONE thing you noticed about Jaylen this week.

THE SITUATION

During reading time, Sofia started feeling really worried about getting an answer wrong. Her tummy felt tight.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What feeling was Sofia having?
- › Is that feeling trying to help her or hurt her?
- › What message was her worried feeling sending?

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THE SITUATION

After playing at recess, Marcus came in feeling really happy. But he didn't want to show it because he thought it looked "babyish."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is it ever "babyish" to feel happy?
- › Why might someone want to hide a good feeling?
- › What are some OK ways to show a happy feeling?

THE SITUATION

Amara accidentally knocked over Jaylen's block tower. She felt terrible and started saying, "I'm so clumsy. I always break things."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is knocking over ONE tower proof that Amara "always" breaks things?
- › What's the difference between "I did something clumsy" and "I AM clumsy"?
- › What are the three steps Amara could do? (Oops → Fix It → Try Again)

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THE SITUATION

Sam forgot his part of the class job and the whole table was messy. He kept saying, "I'm the worst helper ever."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is forgetting ONE time the same as being the worst helper ever?
- › What would a kind friend say to Sam?
- › What is the FIX IT step Sam could do?

THE SITUATION

Priya just got a spelling test back and missed 3 words. Her inside voice said, “See? You're terrible at spelling. You'll never get it right.”

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is that the Kind Coach or Grumpy Gus talking?
- › Is “you'll NEVER get it right” true?
- › What would the Kind Coach say instead?

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THE SITUATION

At PE, Marcus tripped and fell during the relay race. His inside voice said, “Everybody is laughing at you. You are the worst at PE.”

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Grumpy Gus attacking Marcus's BEHAVIOR or WHO HE IS?
- › What are the Three Kind Coach Questions? (What happened? What can I learn? What is one next step?)
- › What would the Kind Coach say to Marcus?

THE SITUATION

Kenji told his friend's secret by accident. When his friend found out, Kenji started thinking, "I am a terrible person. I ruin everything."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is "I am a terrible person" about a BEHAVIOR or about WHO Kenji IS?
- › Which column on our chart does that thought go in?
- › What is the OOPS version of what happened?

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THE SITUATION

After her teacher reminded her to be quiet, Lily started crying and said, "I'm always bad. I can't do anything right."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What did the teacher correct — a behavior or Lily's identity?
- › What column on our chart does Lily's thought go in?
- › Is "I'm always bad" an OOPS or an "I AM BAD"?

BOOK 1 • THE FOUNDATION • GRADES K-2

UNIT 2 • OCT-DEC

Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness

Real Sorry • Letting Go • Kindness Within

LESSONS IN THIS UNIT

L1 What Is Forgiveness, Really?

L2 Carrying Too Much

L3 Saying Sorry and Meaning It

L4 Being Kind to Myself

L5 Letting Go — The Practice

THE SITUATION

After bumping into someone and spilling their lunch, Sofia said, “If I forgive myself, that means it was OK that I did it.” She kept feeling bad for two whole weeks.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is Sofia confused about?
- › Does forgiving yourself mean the thing was OK?
- › If you've already said sorry and tried to fix it, what can you do next?

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THE SITUATION

Elijah accidentally broke a classroom crayon. He fixed it right away and apologized. But every day for a month, he kept saying “I'm so bad.”

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Did Elijah already do the fix-it step?
- › What myth about forgiveness is Elijah believing?
- › What is one thing you would say to help Elijah let it go?

THE SITUATION

Nadia got a math problem wrong on the board in front of everyone. Every time she thinks about math now, her tummy hurts and she doesn't want to try.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Where in her body is Nadia carrying the heavy feeling?
- › Is getting ONE problem wrong proof that she's bad at math?
- › What would you put in Nadia's backpack to help her carry less?

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THE SITUATION

After pushing a classmate at recess (which he already apologized for), Diego didn't want to play with anyone anymore.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Has Diego already done the FIX IT step?
- › What is the heavy feeling still doing to him?
- › What would you say to help Diego feel lighter?

THE SITUATION

Isabella broke her neighbor's toy and told her mom right away. She used her allowance to help pay for a new one. But she keeps feeling terrible about it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Did Isabella do all three parts of a real sorry? (Name what happened, name the hurt, name the change)
- › If you've done all three parts — what can you do next?
- › How do you know when a sorry is complete?

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THE SITUATION

Marcus said "sorry" to a friend he had been mean to, but didn't say what he did or what he would do differently. His friend still felt sad.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Which of the 3 parts of a real sorry did Marcus leave out?
- › Why might just saying "sorry" not be enough?
- › Practice: What would a COMPLETE sorry from Marcus sound like?

THE SITUATION

After falling off her bike, Zara said to herself, “You are so stupid. You can't do anything.” Her friend was right there and heard it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Would Zara say that to her friend if HER friend had fallen?
- › What would Zara say to her friend instead?
- › Can you say that same kind thing to yourself?

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THE SITUATION

When Liam got a low score on his art project, his mom said, “Don't worry, it doesn't matter at all!” But Liam still felt sad.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Why didn't his mom's words help?
- › Is it OK to feel sad about something that matters to you?
- › What would a KIND and HONEST inside voice say?

THE SITUATION

Three months ago, Kayla accidentally wrote on a library book. She told the teacher, paid for it from her allowance, and apologized. But she still feels terrible every time she goes to the library.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Has Kayla done everything the fix-it step requires?
- › What does it mean to “put it down”?
- › What might you say to Kayla to help her let it go?

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THE SITUATION

Connor has been trying to let go of falling off the stage in a class play two years ago. Some days are fine. But sometimes the embarrassment comes back and feels brand new.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Has Connor failed because the feeling keeps coming back?
- › What is the PRACTICE part of letting go?
- › What do you do when you've put it down and it comes back?

BOOK 1 • THE FOUNDATION • GRADES K-2

UNIT 3 • JAN-MAR

Empathy & Forgiving Others

Real Hurt • Forgiveness vs. Trust • The Path

LESSONS IN THIS UNIT

- | | |
|----|---------------------------------------|
| L1 | Your Hurt Is Real |
| L2 | Why Do People Hurt People? |
| L3 | Forgiving Is Not the Same as Trusting |
| L4 | Forgiveness Takes Time |

THE SITUATION

Every day at lunch, a group of kids moved their chairs so Priya had to stand. Nobody said anything mean out loud.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Priya's hurt real, even if no one said a mean word?
- › Does a hurt have to have words to count?
- › What does Priya need before she can even think about forgiveness?

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THE SITUATION

Two years ago, Marcus's best friend stopped inviting him to things. There was no fight, no explanation. Marcus is "mostly over it" but still sometimes feels sad.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Can you be mostly over something AND still have a real hurt?
- › What would you want someone to say to Marcus first?
- › What does Marcus need acknowledged before anything else?

THE SITUATION

During a class presentation, Tyler made a joke about Samira to make the class laugh. Samira felt hurt and embarrassed.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Why do you think Tyler made the joke?
- › Does his reason make the hurt less real for Samira?
- › What's the difference between explaining WHY someone did something and saying it was OK?

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THE SITUATION

After being left out of a group project, Chloe's teacher explained that one girl in the group was having a hard time at home. Chloe said, "So that means it's fine what she did?"

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Chloe right?
- › What's the difference between understanding why and excusing what happened?
- › How would you help Chloe understand the difference?

THE SITUATION

After Jordan told Leila's secret, she apologized sincerely. Their teacher suggested they "make up and be best friends again." Leila said she forgave Jordan but wasn't ready to be best friends again.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Leila's response OK?
- › What are the two separate decisions in this story?
- › Can you forgive someone and still choose not to be close to them?

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THE SITUATION

Nico was left out by a group of kids many times. His counselor encouraged him to forgive them. Nico said, "Does that mean I have to play with them again?"

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What's your answer to Nico's question?
- › Which column is forgiveness in on our chart? Which is trust?
- › Help Nico understand: he can forgive AND still choose to play with other friends.

THE SITUATION

Mia decided three months ago to forgive her friend for spreading a rumour. She said the words. But this week, she felt angry all over again. She thinks, "I'm not a forgiving person."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Mia right that she's not a forgiving person?
- › Where on the Forgiveness Path do you think Mia is right now?
- › What does it mean when the feeling comes back?

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THE SITUATION

Ben's best friend moved away without saying goodbye. Eight months later, Ben is still angry sometimes — but other days he feels fine.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is it wrong to still feel angry eight months later?
- › What does it mean that SOME DAYS ARE BETTER?
- › Where on the Forgiveness Path do you think Ben is?

BOOK 1 • THE FOUNDATION • GRADES K-2

UNIT 4 • MAR-MAY

Grace & Generosity

Benefit of the Doubt • Pause Practice • Grace

LESSONS IN THIS UNIT

- | | |
|----|---------------------------------|
| L1 | What Does Grace Look Like? |
| L2 | Giving the Benefit of the Doubt |
| L3 | Small Acts, Big Difference |
| L4 | Grace With Hard People |

THE SITUATION

When Mateo joined the class mid-year and sat alone at lunch for many days, Ryn walked over and sat with him. Ryn didn't know Mateo at all.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What made Ryn's action an act of grace?
- › Did Mateo do anything to earn Ryn's kindness?
- › What's the difference between grace and just being polite because you're supposed to?

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THE SITUATION

During an argument, Omar said something unkind to his friend Darius. The next day, Darius chose to be friendly to Omar anyway, even though Omar hadn't apologized yet.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What did Darius choose to give that Omar hadn't earned?
- › Is grace a weakness or a strength?
- › How is what Darius did different from being a doormat?

THE SITUATION

Sofia texted her friend group that she couldn't come to a birthday party. Nobody wrote back. Her first thought was, "They're ignoring me on purpose and they're mad."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Was that the most likely reason nobody wrote back?
- › What are some other possible explanations?
- › What would the PAUSE PRACTICE say to do next?

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THE SITUATION

Marcus walked past his classmate Deja without saying anything. Deja's first thought was, "He's still mad at me about something."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is a kinder explanation for why Marcus didn't say hi?
- › What does Step 3 of the Pause Practice say to ask?
- › Practice saying the charitable interpretation out loud.

THE SITUATION

Ms. Abuelo learned every student's name by the second week of school and used it every single day. Years later, students still remembered it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Was learning names a big or small act?
- › What made it meaningful?
- › What's one small act of grace YOU could do in class this week?

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THE SITUATION

Everybody knows Brennan is prickly. He doesn't say thank you or smile. But Kiara decided to keep being kind to him anyway — not because he earned it, but because she chose to.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Kiara being a doormat or practicing grace?
- › What is she basing her choice on?
- › What's the difference between a hard person and an unsafe person?